PRODUCT EXPERIMENTATION · FINAL DELIVERABLE

FinWise, A Product-Led Growth Strategy

Unlock the revenue hidden in an underperforming reverse-trial PLG motion — from a flat 2% activation ceiling to a validated growth, retention, and monetization strategy.

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🔗 Live prototype

SLIDE 2 · THE BET

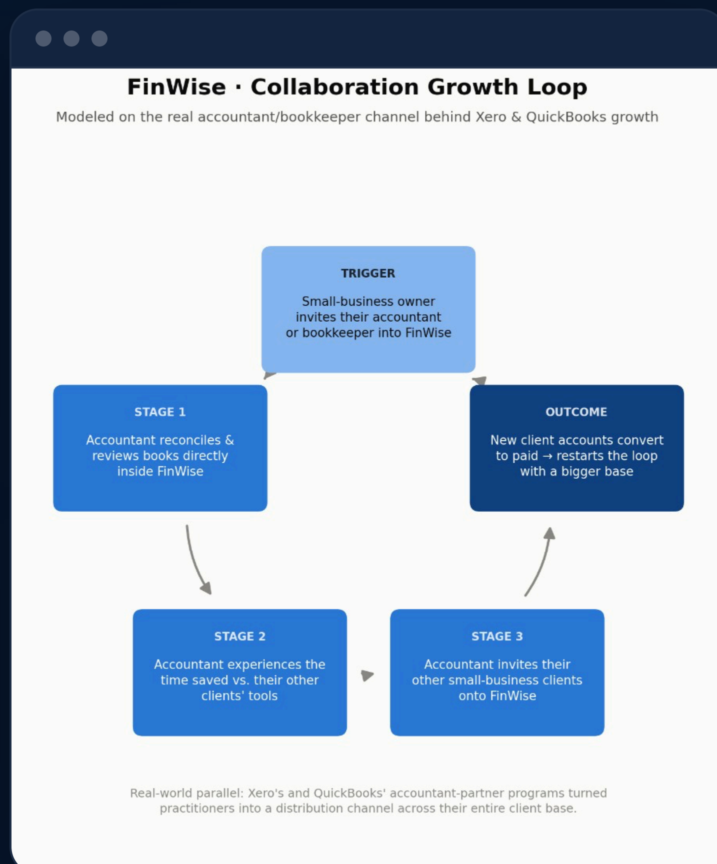
Growth hypothesis & the bet

GROWTH HYPOTHESIS

If we redesign FinWise's trial onboarding to guide new users to complete data import and their first financial model within their first session, trial-to-paid conversion will increase — because 13 months of flat ~2% conversion, regardless of traffic volume, shows activation, not acquisition, is the real blocker.

THE BET

Bet on activation, not acquisition — redesign onboarding around the Aha moment instead of buying more top-of-funnel traffic, backed by a Collaboration growth loop where accountants bring their client base onto FinWise.



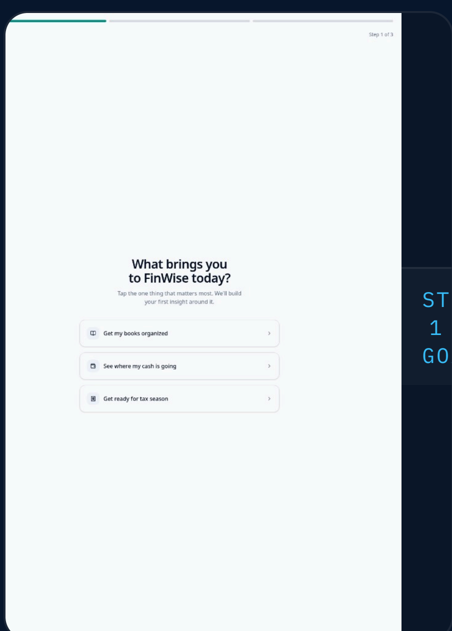
SLIDE 3 · THE SOLUTION

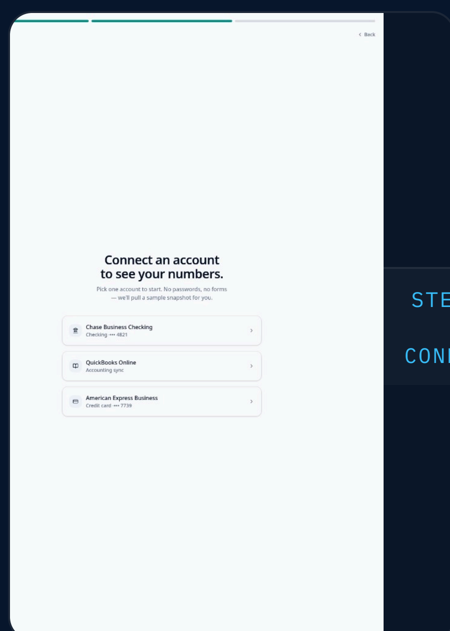
Onboarding & the Aha moment

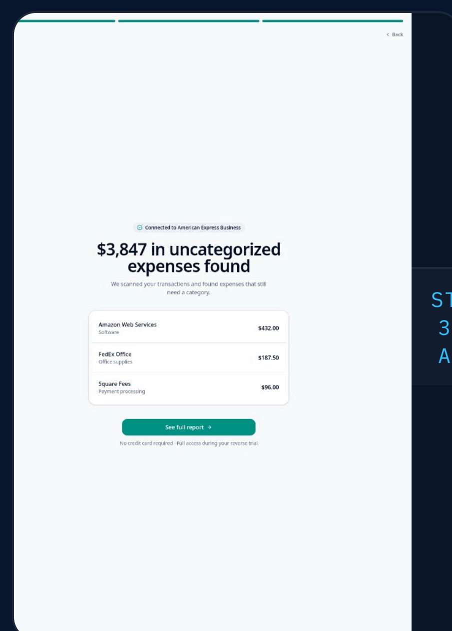
AHA-MOMENT DEFINITION

“I didn't have to build this myself, and now I can actually see my business's numbers clearly.”

The moment a new trial user connects their financial data and sees their first auto-generated report or financial snapshot. This builds directly on the growth bet, where “connecting data and generating a report” is named as FinWise's core value-delivering action. It beats a pure “insights/alerts” moment (like flagging a future cash shortfall) because that needs enough historical data to be meaningful — more of a Habit-stage moment than a Day-1 Aha for a brand-new trial user.







Open onboarding prototype →

SLIDE 4 · THE MECHANIC

Weekly Clear-to-Zero

MECHANIC

The engagement mechanic that builds the habit loop, with rationale and a wireframe.

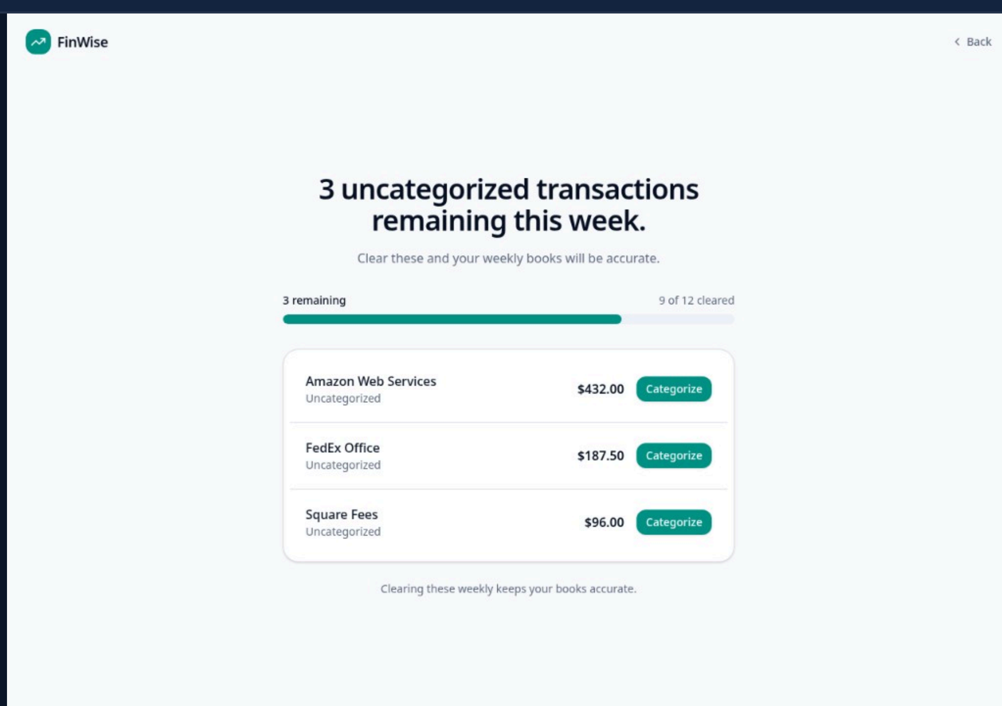
Weekly Clear-to-Zero — a countdown of uncategorized transactions remaining this week, tied to the same problem the Aha moment surfaced.

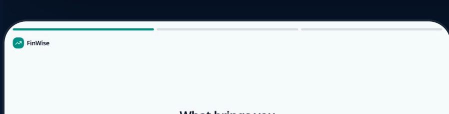
RATIONALE

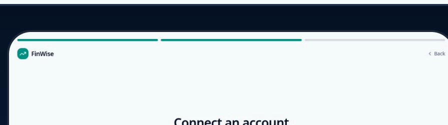
FinWise's 60% one-year churn is value churn: users get their one Aha moment during onboarding, then usage tapers off before it ever becomes a habit.

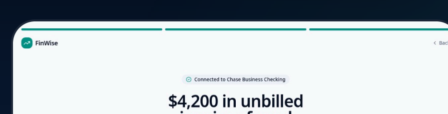
This mechanic is designed to build that habit inside the reverse trial itself — before there's a paywall or renewal decision to react to — so that by the time a user is evaluating whether to keep paying, weekly categorization is already a habit they've built, not a feature they'd have to be sold on.

It's tied directly to real value (accurate books), not an arbitrary point system, which keeps it out of the "reward loop without value" trap.









SLIDE 5 · THE SIGNALS

What we measure

LEADING INDICATORS

Get Started Import Feature Usage % — the exact activation step the onboarding redesign targets; directly upstream of the conversion ceiling.

Financial Modeling Feature Usage % — the second half of the North Star itself, and the behavior the Weekly Clear-to-Zero habit mechanic is built to reinforce; the stronger, though still weak, of the two correlations with conversion.

LAGGING INDICATOR

Trial-to-Paid Conversion Rate — the outcome metric that confirms whether moving the two leading indicators actually shows up in the business result at scale.

DATA PATTERN

~2%

Ceiling — flat 1.87%–2.08% across 13 months

Trial-to-Paid Conversion Rate is a Ceiling — flat in a 1.87%–2.08% band across all 13 months, regardless of how much Visits or Trials swung month to month. The real problem behind that headline number isn't traffic, it's structural: something in the trial experience itself caps conversion at ~2% no matter what.

The four underlying usage/session metrics don't cleanly explain it either — Import % and Modeling % show a dip-then-recover and a noisy-upward pattern that don't map neatly onto a flat ceiling. Correlation: Import % ≈ −0.05 (none), Modeling % ≈ +0.25 (weak).

Likely explanation is an instrumentation gap — these are monthly aggregate usage rates across all active trial users, not one cohort's completion of import → modeling → conversion, so the real signal is probably being diluted by mixing overlapping cohorts.

SLIDE 6 · THE VALIDATION

Experiment brief

Method: Standard A/B Test

Primary: Import Feature Usage %

Guardrail: Trial-to-Paid ≥ ~1.87%

Read date: Day 14

Data Studio report →

METHOD + WHY

Standard A/B Test. Single, self-contained onboarding change tested on a stable population of new trial sign-ups — no shared-environment contamination, no urgent per-user cost that would need a bandit's real-time reallocation.

Standard test gives the cleanest signal without overcomplicating it.

HYPOTHESIS + PRIMARY METRIC

If we replace FinWise's current onboarding with the import-first flow (intent tap → connect account → personalized headline finding), then **Get Started Import Feature Usage %** will increase — our strongest leading indicator toward paid conversion based on prior funnel and usage analysis.

Success threshold: 15% relative increase within the first 14 days of a trial (an assumed target — no formal MDE calculated).

GUARDRAIL + READ DATE

Guardrail: Trial-to-Paid Conversion Rate must not drop below its historical floor of ~1.87%.

Read date: Day 14 of each trial cohort's window. Decided before launch — no peeking early.

SLIDE 7 · THE MODEL

Pricing & packaging

Stage 2 — Revenue Expansion | Reverse-trial + Freemium hybrid | Packaging bet

RECOMMENDATION

Replace the hard trial-expiration cutoff with a real, usable free tier: reconciliation, transaction categorization, and the account-connection flow stay free indefinitely.

Financial Modeling — the forecasting/modeling output that represents FinWise's actual North Star ("reach first modeling output") — sits behind the paywall.

This is a **packaging bet** ("is packaging matched to value?"), not a price increase or a full model change: the price points don't move, the free/paid line does.

The goal is to stop losing the 98% who don't convert in the trial window outright, and instead let them keep building habit on the free tier — creating a second, later opportunity to convert once they hit the modeling wall — rather than forcing a single high-stakes decision at Day 14.

Trade-off: this sacrifices some of the urgency a hard cutoff creates. Accepted cost in exchange for turning acquisition into something that can compound instead of depending entirely on paid channels, which is unsustainable at FinWise's current economics.

STAGE + MODEL

Stage 2 — Revenue Expansion. Value is proven at $10M ARR — the question isn't "does this work," it's "why isn't it converting more of the people who try it." Not Stage 3 yet: packaging and paywall placement still need to land.

Evidence: only 2% convert despite proven demand; 40% one-year retention (60% churn) shows even payers aren't durably committed.

Model: reverse-trial proves value fast (matches the Aha) but fits poorly to recurring financial habit. Hard 14-day cutoff assumes fast decisions; 2% conversion says most don't. Pair with a free tier so non-converters stay in the habit loop.

SUPPORTING SIGNAL

Financial Modeling Feature Usage % — the one leading indicator with a positive (weak but directional) correlation to paid conversion; Import % showed essentially none.

Success: conversions cluster tightly around first attempts to access Financial Modeling.

Guardrail: free-tier retention on reconciliation shouldn't collapse — free must keep users until they hit the modeling wall.

SLIDE 8 · THE STORY

Insights & submit

BIGGEST FRICTION

The instinct was to treat pricing as the fix — it's the most visible lever. Held off until the funnel data actually pointed there, which meant activation came first and pricing followed, as a packaging change, not a price hike.

KEY AHA MOMENT

The 2% conversion number stayed flat for 13 straight months no matter how much traffic changed. That's what turned this from an acquisition problem into an activation one.

TAKEAWAYS

Let the data gate each decision instead of jumping to the obvious lever. A correlation that's weak is still worth reporting honestly, not stretched into a bigger signal than it is.

SUBMIT ON THE LEARNING PLATFORM

View deliverables → 🔗 **Live prototype**